Pacifica Police Dept. - CA

ALPR Policy and Usage

Last Updated: Nov 11, 2026 04:05 AM -08:00

Overview

Pacifica Police Dept. - CA uses Axon Automatic License Plate Reader (ALPR) technology to capture objective evidence without compromising individual privacy. We utilize real-time alerting in patrol vehicles to identify wanted criminals, recover stolen vehicles and locate missing persons that are on various hotlists. All of this data is secure, not sold to 3rd parties, and only used for law enforcement purposes by authorized personnel. This page shows our ALPR policies and usage statistics so that you may understand how this technology is used to help keep your community safer. In an effort to be open with the public to demonstrate our proper usage and communicate what guardrails are in place, we have made the below information available to the public. To view our ALPR Policy directly, please visit us at:
https://www.cityofpacifica.org/home/showpublisheddocument/23946/639274174542770000

ALPR Terms

Hotlist
A list of known license plates and vehicles of interest, which are stolen, wanted for or potentially associated with unlawful activity or missing persons.

Read Record
A record of a plate that was read that was not associated with any hotlist at the time it was captured.

Hit Record
A record of a plate that was read that matched a plate number on a hotlist and generated an alert.

What is detected

License plates of vehicles on public roadways within view of a patrol vehicle's camera, with the date, time, and location of the read.

What is not detected

Facial recognition, registered owner information, gender, race, speed.

Acceptable Use Policy

The in-car systems are used only to alert officers in real time when a plate matches a hotlist. Data is owned by the City of Pacifica and is never sold.

Prohibited Uses

General surveillance, immigration enforcement, enforcement related to lawful reproductive health care, traffic enforcement, harassment or intimidation, usage based solely on a protected class (i.e. race, sex, religion), personal use.

Data Policy Access

The Department does not use this platform to search stored plate reads or to share data with outside agencies. Alerts go only to trained, authorized Pacifica personnel, and the system is audited each quarter.

Hotlist Policy

Hotlist hits are investigative leads only. Officers confirm the plate image and the hotlist record before taking any enforcement action.

Policy Settings

Plate Read Record Retention

30 Days

Usage Metrics

Hotlist Hits Retained

29 Retained

Active ALPR Devices

in the last 30 days

12	12	0	0
Total	Fleet	Outpost	Lightpost